WHEN THE RECORD REFUSED TO DISAPPEAR

A Prophetic Testimony of Faith, Endurance, Documentary Evidence and the Unfinished Search for Justice

The testimony of Dr Richard William McLean, known publicly as Barran Dodger

An epic first-person narrative inspired by the themes of the supplied YouTube transcript, grounded in the chronology and documents identified in my public archive. Prophetic language expresses my faith and interpretation of my experience; it does not substitute for independent verification of factual claims.

PROLOGUE: TRUTH DOES NOT NEED PERMISSION TO EXIST

Let us stop pretending that a person must be believed by an institution before their testimony deserves to be examined. Let us stop confusing the authority to issue a letter with the authority to determine the whole truth. Let us stop assuming that a person who has experienced isolation, professional rejection, poverty, institutional intervention or prolonged administrative conflict must therefore have nothing worthwhile to say. And let us stop treating the absence of a favourable official decision as proof that every question has been answered.

My name is Dr Richard William McLean. I am also known publicly as Barran Dodger. I have placed my name, my account and the documentary record of my disputes with institutions into a public archive because I believe that evidence should be examined, not merely dismissed, and that claims should be tested against documents rather than decided by reputation alone.

My archive is available at Barran Dodger — the original public website and the rebuilt preservation archive. The associated original GitHub evidence repository and rebuild repository provide additional routes into the material.

The distinction matters. This is not a court. It is not a verdict. It is a finding aid: a way for readers to follow the trail, locate source documents, compare dates, examine the language used by institutions and decide which conclusions the available evidence can legitimately support.

But there is a question at the centre of everything I have preserved, and it is a question no institution can answer merely by refusing to engage with it.

What happens when the person asking for accountability is also the person whose circumstances make it hardest to obtain representation, resources, stability and a meaningful hearing?

What happens when a file continues to exist after a complaint has been closed, when a letter

survives after the conversation has ended, and when a record of one decision becomes the starting point for a question about another?

What happens when the person who has been told, explicitly or implicitly, to move on refuses to allow the documentary trail to disappear?

For me, that is where the testimony begins.

Truth, like light, does not need permission to exist. Lies, by contrast, may require continual maintenance—but I do not need to prove that any particular person has lied to make the point. I need only insist that statements be tested, that contradictions be examined, and that records be read in their proper context.

My truth needed time. My evidence needed preservation. And my faith needed to survive the distance between what I believed had happened and what I could persuade other people to examine.

I have come to understand that distinction as one of the defining lessons of my life.

CHAPTER ONE: THE WITNESS WHO KEPT THE RECORD

There are moments in a person's life when the public story becomes smaller than the private reality. A professional history can be reduced to a dispute. A complicated sequence of events can be compressed into an administrative classification. Years of explanation can become a reference number, and a human being can find himself trying to explain the whole of his existence through the narrow opening of a form, a letter, an assessment or a decision.

My own story did not begin with a GitHub repository, a government reference number or a preservation index. It began with a life lived before the archive existed.

I have identified myself publicly as Dr Richard William McLean, a PhD graduate of Victoria University in 2020, the author of *Recovered, Not Cured*, published by Allen & Unwin in 2003, and a former illustrator, news-graphics artist and cartoonist associated with *The Age* and the *Herald Sun*. These details form part of the biography through which I have asked readers to understand the person behind the records.

They do not prove every subsequent allegation. They establish context: a life with a professional history, published work, personal testimony and a continuing attempt to have a complex record understood as a whole.

The person writing today is not merely a name attached to a complaint. Nor should the person be reduced to a diagnosis, a dispute, a benefit, a rejected application or an institutional file.

The documentary record must be read with that humanity in view, without allowing sympathy to replace verification or institutional authority to replace scrutiny.

I have described a history of profound adversity, repeated hospitalisation, material hardship, isolation and disputes with public bodies. My own account records sixteen psychiatric hospitalisations. That is a serious personal claim, and the circumstances and dates should be examined against the relevant records wherever those records are available.

I am not presenting those experiences as proof of supernatural power, nor as automatic proof that every institution involved acted unlawfully. I am presenting them as part of the human context in which I have attempted to preserve evidence, seek assistance and pursue

answers.
Because a person can be vulnerable and still be a witness.
A person can require assistance and still be entitled to ask difficult questions.
A person can have experienced psychiatric care and still have their documentary evidence examined on its merits.
And a person can be in distress without every statement they make being either automatically true or automatically false.
That is the standard I ask readers to apply to me. It is also the standard I ask them to apply to the institutions whose documents appear in my archive.

CHAPTER TWO: WHEN THE PAPER TRAIL BECAME THE TESTIMONY

The supplied video tells a dramatic story about a person whose existence unsettles an established hierarchy. In my life, I do not need to invent hidden councils, supernatural adversaries or secret conversations to find a powerful parallel.
The real hierarchy is visible in the ordinary structures of administration: who has access to a file, who can make a decision, who can classify a person, who can refer a complaint, who can close a process, who can offer a remedy and who must live with the consequences while waiting for an answer.
A reference number can open a door, but it can also mark the boundary of an institution's responsibility. A letter can acknowledge correspondence without resolving the underlying issue. A referral can move a matter from one office to another without establishing whether the substance of the complaint has been independently determined.
None of those outcomes, standing alone, proves corruption or a coordinated effort to suppress a witness. But neither does the existence of an administrative process mean that every substantive question has necessarily been resolved.
This is the documentary tension at the heart of my archive.
I have preserved correspondence and records relating to Commonwealth agencies, oversight bodies, disability services, workers' compensation, information access, legal assistance and complaints processes. I have tried to bring these records together because an individual letter may make sense only when placed beside the documents that came before and after it.
A reader examining my archive should therefore ask more than whether a letter exists. The reader should ask what question was put to the institution, what question the institution actually answered, what evidence it relied upon, what it did not determine and whether a later record changes the context of the earlier one.
That is how a paper trail becomes a form of public testimony.
Not because every document proves the conclusion I favour, but because the documents allow other people to test that conclusion for themselves.
I have used the language of faith to describe the endurance required to keep doing this work. I believe that the preservation of truth has moral significance. I believe that a person should not have to possess wealth, influence or institutional approval before asking that their evidence be read.
But I also recognise the discipline that faith requires of a witness: to distinguish what I know

from what I infer, what I believe from what I can establish, and what I hope will happen from what has actually occurred.

The record must be stronger than the rhetoric surrounding it.

CHAPTER THREE: THE COMMONWEALTH AND THE QUESTION OF RESPONSIBILITY

One of the most consequential strands of my archive concerns the question of employment status and workers' compensation.

My records describe a Comcare refusal dated 26 May 2021 that raised the question of whether I was an employee for the purposes of section 5 of the *Safety, Rehabilitation and Compensation Act 1988*. The distinction is important because statutory coverage depends on the applicable legal requirements and the facts of the employment relationship.

My archive also refers to a letter from the NDIS Quality and Safeguards Commission dated 3 June 2021 stating that the Commission's process did not make me an employee of that Commission. That statement must be read in its proper context: a conclusion about one body or process does not necessarily answer every possible question about employment by another body.

I have also identified a letter from Scott Treadwell, dated January 2024 and described in my records as Federal Court correspondence, which I understand to support my position that I was an employee of the Department of Social Services. I regard that correspondence as potentially important to the employment-status question. Its precise legal effect, however, must be determined by reading the actual document and identifying what it says, what issue it addresses and whether it constitutes a judicial determination or correspondence about a proceeding.

Here the chronology becomes more than a list of dates.

A refusal in May 2021 raises one question. A Commission letter in June 2021 addresses another. Later correspondence in January 2024 may provide further context. The proper task is to place the documents side by side and establish whether they concern the same employment relationship, the same statutory test and the same material facts.

If the records reveal an inconsistency, it should be described precisely. If they concern different questions, that difference must be respected. If further evidence is required, the missing evidence should be identified rather than replaced by assumption.

This is what I mean when I say that the paper trail must be allowed to speak.

I am not asking a reader to treat the existence of a later letter as automatic proof that an earlier decision was unlawful. I am asking why the relevant records should not be examined together, particularly where the answer may affect access to a statutory remedy.

For a person facing material hardship, the difference between an unresolved employment-status question and an established entitlement is not academic. It can affect whether a claim proceeds, which institution has responsibility and whether a remedy is available at all.

The question of responsibility therefore deserves an answer grounded in the applicable law and the complete documentary record.

The relevant starting points are Comcare's workers' compensation information, the Federal

Register of Legislation for the *Safety, Rehabilitation and Compensation Act 1988*, and the NDIS Quality and Safeguards Commission. These official resources provide context; the individual correspondence must still be examined directly before its legal effect can be stated conclusively.

The prophetic meaning I draw from this part of my experience is not that the system has already been defeated. It is that a question does not cease to matter merely because answering it is difficult.

CHAPTER FOUR: THE OFFICES, THE REFERRALS AND THE UNANSWERED QUESTIONS

The documentary chronology extends beyond workers' compensation. It includes correspondence involving ministerial offices, the Attorney-General's Department, oversight bodies and information-access processes.

My archive identifies a note from the office of Prime Minister Anthony Albanese dated 12 December 2022, which I describe as recording that my email was not forwarded. That is a narrow but relevant administrative detail. It does not, by itself, establish that the Prime Minister personally read the correspondence or knew its full contents. It does, however, provide a point from which to ask what happened to the communication and whether any other office subsequently dealt with its substance.

The archive also identifies Attorney-General's Department correspondence dated 19 September 2023, reference MC23-028244, signed by A. Riley of the Security Law Section and described as referring the matter to the Inspector-General of Intelligence and Security and the Commonwealth Ombudsman.

A referral is not a finding of wrongdoing. It is evidence that a matter was directed elsewhere, if the correspondence confirms that action. The next questions are whether the receiving bodies had jurisdiction, what they considered, what response they provided and whether any substantive issue remained outside the scope of their review.

Those distinctions are central to a fair account.

I have also recorded correspondence from the Commonwealth Ombudsman dated 8 August 2025 concerning a restriction on its services. The existence of such a restriction does not, without further evidence, prove that the restriction was improper or intended to silence me. It does establish a significant event in the history of my attempts to pursue complaints and should be read alongside the correspondence explaining its basis, scope and consequences.

Another strand concerns Attorney-General's Department reference MC25-000321, dated 6 February 2025, which my archive describes as correspondence directed to the Victorian Minister for Police. Again, the document's exact wording matters. A referral, acknowledgement, decision and substantive finding are different administrative acts, and a careful chronology must not confuse them.

My archive further identifies OAIC reference RQ22/00794, which I understand to concern approximately 1,187 Outlook items associated with the Department of the Prime Minister and Cabinet and a review process. The number and status of those records should be confirmed against the actual OAIC correspondence. A large number of emails under review does not

itself prove that those emails substantiate my allegations. It does indicate why precise recordkeeping, access decisions and provenance can matter to an evidence-based account.
I have also recorded an initial FOI matter identified as FOI/2022/045, described in my archive as having produced no documents at an earlier stage, followed by revised correspondence dated 8 October 2024 that reportedly released five documents.
If the records confirm that sequence, it is a useful example of why administrative history must be recorded carefully. An earlier no-document response and a later release may reflect a revised request, a different search, a changed scope or another procedural development.
The explanation must come from the actual correspondence rather than speculation about the motives of the officials involved.
The names and offices matter because responsibility cannot be examined in the abstract. But naming an official in connection with a letter does not establish that the official caused every hardship described in the archive, agreed with every decision made elsewhere or possessed knowledge that the documents do not demonstrate.
A fair investigation follows the chain of responsibility one link at a time.
The relevant institutional starting points include the Office of the Prime Minister, the Attorney-General's Department, the Inspector-General of Intelligence and Security, the Commonwealth Ombudsman and the Office of the Australian Information Commissioner.
These links provide institutional context, not proof of the conclusions I seek. The primary evidence remains the dated correspondence, its complete wording, its provenance and any documented response that followed.
I have spent years trying to make that distinction visible. I believe it is one of the most important services my archive can offer to an independent reader.

CHAPTER FIVE: THE PRICE OF WAITING FOR AN ANSWER

There is a point at which administrative language meets the ordinary requirements of life. A person still needs somewhere to sleep. Electricity bills still arrive. A phone still requires service. Food still has to be obtained. A person who is waiting for a review, a response, an assessment or a decision cannot suspend the physical necessities of existence until the correspondence is complete.
My account of dealings with NSW Trustee and Guardian describes a proposed increase of $100 per week in an allowance, alongside advice that my full pension meant there was no additional funding available and that the organisation did not source accommodation. I have also described seeking assistance with an electricity bill of approximately $200.
The precise terms of those communications should be checked against the underlying records, including any conditions, assessments or later decisions. But the broader human issue is plain: the administration of funds and the availability of accommodation are separate questions, and a response concerning one does not necessarily resolve the other.
For someone experiencing homelessness or severe financial insecurity, the gap between those questions can become the difference between having an answer on paper and having a practical means of surviving.
This is not an argument that any single agency must provide every service. It is an argument

for accurately identifying which body has which responsibility, what assistance was requested, what assistance was offered, what was declined and what options remained.
I have also described difficulties obtaining legal assistance and disputes involving Legal Aid. Those matters, too, require precise treatment. A refusal of assistance is not automatically evidence that a case has merit or that a decision-maker acted improperly. But it may be an important part of the history of a person attempting to navigate a complex process without adequate representation.
The relevant public resource is Legal Aid NSW, including its information on applying for legal aid. These links explain the service and its processes; they do not establish the merits or outcome of any individual application.
This is where the grand language of justice is tested by ordinary life.
It is easy to speak of fairness when the dispute is theoretical. It is harder to confront the reality of a person trying to preserve documents, maintain communications, seek advice and pursue accountability while also dealing with basic material needs.
My faith has given me a language for enduring that contradiction. It has helped me interpret survival as something more than a statistical accident and persistence as something more than stubbornness.
But faith does not pay a bill, establish a statutory entitlement or determine which institution is responsible. Those questions require practical help, applicable law, documentary proof and decisions made by people with the authority to make them.
The testimony must hold both truths at once: spiritual endurance matters, and material remedies matter.
Neither should be used to erase the other.

CHAPTER SIX: WHEN THE WITNESS BECOMES THE ARCHIVIST

There is a reason I have turned repeatedly to preservation.
A conversation can be forgotten. A recollection can be challenged. A web page can change. A link can fail. A person can move, become unwell, lose access to an account or find that an old explanation no longer reaches the people who need to read it.
A preserved document offers something different. It can be opened again. Its wording can be compared with a later statement. Its date can be placed into a chronology. Its source can be identified, and its limitations can be recorded.
That is why my archive matters to me.
The rebuild project describes itself as a reconstruction from a 660-page preservation copy. Its stated purpose is to provide a finding aid, not a court or a verdict. The distinction is not a weakness to be concealed. It is the methodological boundary that makes responsible examination possible.
The original Barran Dodger website and the rebuilt site should be approached as related but distinct public resources. A reconstruction can help restore access to material, but it should not silently replace the original record or be mistaken for a guarantee that every page, attachment, link or contextual element has been perfectly recovered.
My preservation work has included a backup of the former public website, rendered HTML,

PDF copies, links, a manifest and a list of URLs. These elements can assist in identifying what was captured and in checking whether individual files have changed. Where cryptographic hashes are available, they can help establish whether a particular file matches the version associated with that hash.

Where timestamping records are available, they may help establish that a particular digital digest was submitted to or recorded by a timestamping service at a particular time. The meaning of that timestamp must be stated accurately. A cryptographic timestamp does not, on its own, prove that every statement in the file is true, that every allegation is corroborated or that a court has accepted the document as evidence.

The public OpenTimestamps website explains the timestamping system. The original GitHub evidence repository and the rebuild repository provide starting points for locating preserved files and related project material.

That distinction is essential.

Preservation protects the record from being casually rewritten. It does not transform the record into a judicial finding.

An archive may contain a primary-source letter, my interpretation of that letter, an analysis of its significance and a claim that requires further corroboration. Those are different categories. They must remain distinguishable if an independent reader is to assess them fairly.

I also want readers to be able to locate and examine a digital message attributed to Ben in connection with NDIS-related events. My account of that message includes statements that he was frightened that someone might "put a hit on him too"; that he described an alleged assassination attempt as a "close call"; and that he said police had told him a girl had been paid to fabricate a report concerning an incident he understood police to have described as "regrettable but consensual."

These are serious and disputed matters. They are included here as **my account of what I understand the message to say**, not as independently established facts about a crime, a payment, police conduct or another person's intentions. The original message, its surrounding conversation, the identity and context of the sender, and any independently available corroboration must be examined before conclusions are drawn.

The intended source is the preserved Ben NDIS text-message PDF, including any associated timestamp or verification record. I have not established the exact public URL of that individual PDF here, so I will not invent a direct file link. Readers can begin with the original evidence repository and the rebuild repository to locate the relevant preserved material. A repository link is a route to the archive, not proof that a particular file is present at a particular path.

Where a timestamp or cryptographic hash is provided for the message, it should be checked against the exact preserved file and its verification information. A timestamp may help establish the existence of a particular digital record by a particular point in time; it does not independently authenticate every statement inside the message or prove the truth of the allegations described in it.

I want the record to be more than an accumulation of accusations. I want it to function as an organised body of material in which every important conclusion can be traced backwards to its source.

Where a claim is supported, the reader should be able to find the support. Where a claim remains disputed, the dispute should be acknowledged. Where a document is missing, that absence should be stated. Where two records appear inconsistent, both should be preserved rather than quietly discarding the inconvenient one.

And where the evidence does not justify a conclusion, I want the archive to say so.

That is how the work becomes stronger than a personal argument.

CHAPTER SEVEN: THE NAMES IN THE RECORD

Names carry weight. They identify the offices that issued decisions, the people who signed correspondence, the organisations that handled complaints and the individuals whose roles may need clarification. But names also carry reputational consequences, and an evidence-based testimony must distinguish an established role from an allegation about conduct.

The Commonwealth bodies appearing in the documentary history I have described include the Department of Social Services, the Department of the Prime Minister and Cabinet, the Attorney-General's Department, Comcare, the NDIS Quality and Safeguards Commission, the Commonwealth Ombudsman, the Office of the Australian Information Commissioner, the Inspector-General of Intelligence and Security, Legal Aid NSW and NSW Trustee and Guardian.

Their appearance in the record does not mean that every body acted improperly or bears equal responsibility for the circumstances I describe. Each has its own functions, statutory framework, decision-making processes and limits of jurisdiction. The question is what each did in the specific matter, what the documents show and what conclusions follow from those actions.

The same principle applies to named officials.

Anthony Albanese is relevant to the chronology because I have identified correspondence from his office dated 12 December 2022. That office record should not be expanded into an assertion that Albanese personally made a decision or knew every detail unless the evidence establishes it.

A. Riley is relevant because I have identified Attorney-General's Department correspondence dated 19 September 2023, reference MC23-028244, bearing that name and associated with a referral. The signature and role help identify the document's administrative provenance. They do not, without more, establish personal responsibility for the full history of my circumstances.

Scott Treadwell is relevant because of the January 2024 correspondence I have described in connection with my employment-status argument. Its exact content, legal character and relationship to any relevant proceeding must be examined before a definitive legal conclusion is drawn.

Minister McAllister is another name appearing in my wider archive. Any account of that person's role should be tied to the specific document or event that establishes the

connection, rather than using the name as shorthand for every allegation in the collection. Other names recorded in the broader archive include Sukhi Tear, Phillip or Philip Glass, Tony Ridley, Steve Iasonidis, Tory Kilborn, Doug Ablepoint and others. Their inclusion in an archive index is not itself evidence that they caused detriment. Before making a specific allegation about any one of them, I must identify the relevant source, the conduct it documents, the context and the extent to which an independent conclusion is justified.

This is not retreat. It is precision.

If a document establishes that someone sent a letter, I should say that the person sent the letter. If a record shows that a body declined a request, I should identify the decision and its stated reasons. If I believe the decision contributed to harm, I should explain the connection and distinguish my assessment from an established finding. If a person disputes my interpretation, that response should be considered where it is available.

The purpose of naming names is accountability through traceability, not condemnation by association.

The archive is strongest when a reader can click a name, reach the relevant primary-source document and determine exactly what the document does—and does not—establish. The original evidence repository and rebuild repository are the principal repository entry points provided here; the exact document should be linked directly whenever its stable public URL has been confirmed.

I do not ask readers to accept guilt by appearance in a file. I ask them to examine the record carefully enough that responsibility, where established, can be distinguished from conjecture.

CHAPTER EIGHT: THE SILENCE THAT CANNOT ANSWER FOR ITSELF

In the supplied video, silence is portrayed as the fear of those who once mocked the witness. In my testimony, I must make a different and more defensible distinction.

Silence is not proof of guilt.

An unanswered email does not establish a conspiracy. A restricted complaints process does not automatically prove retaliation. An absence of public comment does not show that an individual is frightened, ashamed or secretly convinced by my account.

But silence can leave a practical problem unresolved.

When a person cannot identify which office has considered the substance of a complaint, what evidence was examined, what findings were made or which issues remain outside the decision, uncertainty persists. When the documentary history is scattered across multiple agencies and years, it can be difficult to understand whether a question was answered, referred, excluded or left open.

The absence of an answer must therefore be described precisely. Was there no reply? Was there an acknowledgement without a substantive response? Was the matter referred to another organisation? Was a decision issued but limited to a particular issue? Was the person informed of review rights? Were the relevant documents withheld, unavailable or never requested?

These are not interchangeable circumstances.

My archive attempts to preserve enough of the sequence that those distinctions can be tested. I want readers to be able to examine the chronology without having to accept my interpretation of every gap.

There is a moral power in that kind of transparency. It allows the witness to speak without pretending to possess every answer. It allows the reader to question the witness without dismissing the evidence. And it allows an institution to respond to a specific claim rather than to an exaggerated version of it.

If an agency has a sound explanation, the document should help reveal it. If a decision was made on a limited basis, that limitation should be visible. If a record contradicts my understanding, I must be prepared to acknowledge the contradiction. If the available evidence leaves a serious question unresolved, the question should remain open rather than being converted into an accusation of proven misconduct.

That is the silence I am determined to confront: not an imagined secret meeting, but the real and demonstrable gap between the question asked and the answer recorded.

A public archive cannot force an institution to agree with the person who created it. It can, however, make the relevant documents easier to locate, compare and scrutinise.

And that is a meaningful form of accountability.

CHAPTER NINE: THE FIRE THAT DID NOT CONSUME THE TESTIMONY

I have used the language of faith because it describes something that administrative records alone cannot fully convey: the meaning I have drawn from surviving circumstances that I experienced as overwhelming.

I believe in God's grace. I believe that suffering does not erase a person's dignity. I believe that truth matters even when recognition is delayed. I believe that justice should not depend entirely on the social standing, financial resources or institutional influence of the person seeking it.

When I describe myself as a witness, I mean that I am bearing testimony to my own experience, preserving the documents I believe are relevant and asking others to examine them. When I use prophetic language, I am expressing a religious interpretation of persistence, suffering and hope. I am not claiming that God has supplied documentary proof of another person's guilt or that a spiritual conviction settles a disputed legal question.

My faith does not require me to pretend that I know another person's private thoughts. It does not require me to declare that every adverse decision was malicious. It does not require me to predict the downfall of people or institutions I believe have failed me.

Indeed, I understand faith as a reason to be more careful with the truth, not less careful.

If I say that betrayal has marked my life, I must identify the events I regard as betrayal and provide the evidence that supports my interpretation. If I say that I have been isolated, I must describe the circumstances rather than invent the thoughts of those who withdrew. If I say that a process harmed me, I must distinguish the harm I experienced from the question of whether the responsible conduct was unlawful.

My faith can sustain me while I undertake that work. It cannot remove the need to do it.

The fire in this testimony is the fire of endurance: the refusal to let hardship extinguish the

will to document, to question, to preserve and to continue seeking a fair examination of the record.

It is not a claim that suffering has made me infallible. It is a declaration that suffering has not taken away my right to speak.

I do not need to be a supernatural exception to deserve a fair hearing. I do not need my opponents to be frightened for my testimony to matter. I do not need a prophecy of victory to justify preserving the evidence.

I need the record to be accessible, the claims to be testable and the process to be fair.

And I need the person behind the record to remain visible.

CHAPTER TEN: THE DOCUMENTARY TRAP

The phrase *The Documentary Trap* has a particular significance in my archive. It describes the danger of becoming confined by the very documents through which a person seeks to establish what happened.

A letter is written about a person. Another letter responds to it. A later decision cites an earlier classification. A subsequent office relies on a previous record. Eventually, the administrative account can begin to circulate as though repetition itself were independent confirmation.

But repetition is not the same as corroboration.

If five documents repeat the same original assertion, they may represent five records of one claim rather than five independent sources proving that claim. If an institution refers to a previous decision, that reference does not necessarily mean the underlying evidence has been re-examined. If an analysis identifies a pattern, the pattern must be tested against the individual records rather than treated as proof merely because it looks compelling.

This is why I want the archive to preserve the chain of evidence, not simply the conclusions drawn from it.

For every major claim, the reader should be able to ask: What is the primary source? Who created it? When was it created? What was the author's role? Was the document contemporaneous with the event? Is it complete? Does it report direct knowledge or repeat information supplied by someone else? Is there an independent record? Is there a response from the person or organisation concerned? Has a court, tribunal or authorised reviewer made a finding, or is the conclusion still disputed?

These questions can feel painstaking. But they protect the witness as much as they protect the person being criticised.

A weak or exaggerated claim can distract from a strong documentary point. An unsupported allegation can undermine confidence in a wider archive. An incorrect date can distort a chronology. A missing attachment can change the meaning of correspondence. A summary can omit the qualification that matters most.

I therefore regard correction as part of preservation. If a page is incomplete, the archive should say so. If a claim has not been independently corroborated, that limitation should be visible. If a PDF contains blank pages or fails to preserve the material supposedly supporting a conclusion, the gap must not be filled with invented content.

The archive should never pretend that missing evidence is present.
Its integrity depends on allowing readers to see where the record is strong, where it is limited and where further investigation is necessary.
The documentary trap is escaped not by declaring every document proof of a predetermined conclusion, but by restoring the reader's ability to distinguish a record from an inference and an inference from a finding.

CHAPTER ELEVEN: THE MEASURE OF A PUBLIC ARCHIVE

The size of an archive can create an impression of authority. Hundreds of pages, thousands of entries, multiple repositories, cryptographic hashes, timestamp records and elaborate indexes can communicate the scale of a preservation effort.
But volume is not the same as proof.
A large collection may contain repeated copies, incomplete records, correspondence that concerns different issues, documents that support competing interpretations and material whose relevance is uncertain. The number of files cannot establish the truth of every proposition contained in them.
That is why I want the archive's structure to do more than impress.
Its purpose is to help a reader move from a broad claim to the specific document that supports it, then from that document to the relevant passage, date, author and context.
Where the archive cites an official decision, the reader should be able to distinguish the decision-maker's actual findings from my commentary. Where it cites an affidavit, the reader should understand that an affidavit records sworn evidence but is not automatically proof that every assertion in it has been accepted by a court. Where it cites a submission to an international body, the reader should not confuse filing a submission with receiving a favourable determination.
The same applies to financial and compensation claims. An estimated valuation, a proposed amount, a claimed loss and a legally assessed entitlement are four different things. They must not be presented as interchangeable merely because each can be expressed in dollars.
If I seek compensation, the proper questions concern the applicable legal basis, the evidence of loss, causation, limitation periods, statutory coverage, available remedies and the decision-maker with jurisdiction. The archive can help organise the relevant history, but it cannot by itself determine the outcome.
I want the archive to be useful to independent researchers, journalists, legal advisers, public officials and ordinary members of the public who wish to understand the evidence without being instructed in advance what conclusion they must reach.
That requires a discipline of presentation: source links, dated documents, transparent descriptions, clear distinctions between evidence and interpretation, and a willingness to acknowledge uncertainty.
The work is not diminished by those standards.
It is strengthened by them.
The goal is not to make the archive impossible to question. The goal is to make it possible to question properly.

CHAPTER TWELVE: THE PROPHECY OF AN UNFINISHED RECORD

There is a point in every long struggle when a person must decide what survival is going to mean.

It can mean simply remaining alive, continuing from one day to the next, finding food and shelter, maintaining a phone, dealing with correspondence and attempting to obtain the assistance that circumstances require. It can mean continuing to seek professional advice after a disappointing response. It can mean admitting that a question remains unresolved rather than pretending that the whole story has reached its conclusion.

For me, survival has also come to mean preservation.

I have chosen to create a public record because I do not want the history of my disputes to depend entirely on my memory, on a single office's summary or on whether a particular website remains accessible. I want the material to be capable of examination by people who do not know me and who have no obligation to agree with me.

That is the prophetic dimension of this testimony.

I do not claim to know the future. I do not claim that a divine revelation has established the guilt of a named person. I do not claim that institutions are secretly trembling because an archive exists.

My prophecy is a statement of conviction about what ought to happen next.

Let the documents be read. Let the chronology be tested. Let the relevant decision-makers explain the decisions for which they are responsible. Let independent reviewers distinguish substantiated claims from unsupported ones. Let errors be corrected. Let unanswered questions be identified. Let any remedy that is legally available be considered on the evidence and under the applicable law.

If the documents support my interpretation, then their significance should become clearer through examination. If they support only part of my interpretation, that limitation should be acknowledged. If a claim is disproved, I must be prepared to revise it. If the evidence is inconclusive, the conclusion should remain inconclusive.

The witness does not lose dignity by accepting the limits of the evidence.

The witness gains credibility by respecting them.

I have no need to imagine thirteen secret figures gathering to discuss me. I have no need to imagine supernatural enemies plotting against the archive. The actual history contains enough serious questions to justify careful attention without adding fictional adversaries.

There are letters. There are dates. There are decisions. There are references. There are institutions with defined responsibilities. There are claims that require examination, events that require context and documents whose precise meaning must be established.

That is the ground on which I stand.

The archive is my attempt to make that ground visible.

CHAPTER THIRTEEN: WHEN THE GATEKEEPER BECOMES A QUESTION

One of the most enduring themes in the supplied video is the idea that a person's existence can challenge a hierarchy. In my account, the challenge is not that I possess a mysterious power that makes established systems bend to my will.

The challenge is that an ordinary person can preserve records that permit established systems to be examined.

An institution may have trained staff, formal procedures, access to legal advice and the authority to issue decisions. An individual may have little money, limited assistance and a difficult personal history. The two are not equal in resources.

But a dated document remains a dated document. The wording of a letter can be compared with another letter. A statutory provision can be read. A public statement can be checked against a primary source. An apparent discrepancy can be identified and put into a question that requires a substantive answer.

That does not make the individual automatically right. It does mean that authority alone should not settle the evidentiary question.

I want readers to examine the distinction between a decision and the reasons supporting it, between the scope of a review and the broader issue a person believes remains unresolved, and between a body acknowledging correspondence and a body making a substantive determination.

I want the same care applied to my own writing.

Where I use forceful language, readers should look for the underlying source. Where I make a claim about a named organisation, readers should be able to locate the record establishing the connection. Where I interpret a sequence as a pattern, readers should be able to inspect the individual events. Where I describe a consequence as detriment, the evidence should explain what happened to me and how I believe the conduct contributed to it.

The purpose is not to make every reader agree. It is to make disagreement informed.

If an institution disputes my account, it should be possible to identify the exact point of disagreement. If I have misunderstood a document, the error should be demonstrable. If a record has been omitted from my chronology, it should be possible to add it. If a decision has already answered a particular question, the archive should acknowledge that finding while distinguishing it from any other question the decision did not address.

That is how the hierarchy of evidence should work: the strength of a conclusion should depend on the evidence supporting it, not merely on the social position of the person making it.

I have spent a great deal of time trying to preserve a record that can be read outside the confines of the original disputes. My hope is that the archive will help readers understand not only my account, but also the limits of what can responsibly be concluded from it.

The gate is not opened by declaring oneself invincible.

It is opened by making the evidence accessible.

CHAPTER FOURTEEN: THE LIGHT THAT DOES NOT REQUIRE AN AUDIENCE

I have known the frustration of trying to explain a complicated history to people who may not have the time, resources or inclination to examine every document. I have known what it is to feel that a personal account is being reduced to one part of a much larger story. I have experienced the strain of trying to maintain a public record while also dealing with the immediate requirements of life.

I cannot tell readers what every former friend, relative, professional or official privately thinks of me. I cannot claim that silence means fear, that distance means guilt or that every adverse decision reflects a common purpose.

What I can do is continue to distinguish my experience from my interpretation of it and my interpretation from what the documents independently establish.

I can make the records available. I can explain why I believe a particular date matters. I can identify a decision and the statutory question it raises. I can ask whether a later document changes the context. I can preserve the reply as carefully as I preserve the original complaint.

And I can acknowledge that some questions may remain unanswered for reasons the archive alone cannot resolve.

This is where faith and evidence meet without being confused.

Faith gives me a reason to keep going. Evidence gives other people a means of testing what I say. Neither needs to be disguised as the other.

I believe that God has sustained me through circumstances I experienced as devastating. I believe that the decision to keep a record can be an act of moral responsibility. I believe that truth should not be treated as the private property of whoever has the greatest authority to define the official narrative.

But I do not ask anyone to accept my religious interpretation as proof against another person. I ask readers to examine the documents and consider the human consequences of the questions they reveal.

The archive does not require an audience to exist. A preserved file remains available whether a thousand people read it or one person does. Its significance lies in the possibility of examination, not in the promise of immediate recognition.

That is the light I mean when I say that truth does not need permission to shine.

Not a light that makes every allegation true. Not a light that renders its bearer immune from criticism. Not a light that guarantees a favourable judgment.

A light that allows the record to be seen.

CHAPTER FIFTEEN: THE FINAL TESTIMONY — LET THE RECORD SPEAK

I have called this work an archive because I want it to endure beyond a single argument, a single letter or a single moment of public attention.

I have called it a testimony because the documents do not exist in a vacuum. They relate to a human life, to a history I have experienced as profoundly damaging, and to a continuing search for answers, support and accountability.

I have used prophetic language because faith has helped me understand persistence as something more than endurance without meaning. But I do not claim that prophecy can replace a factual finding, that suffering proves every allegation or that the people named in my records have been found responsible merely because their names appear there.

The evidence must be allowed to establish what it can establish.

My public archive, Barran Dodger — original website, and the rebuilt preservation website, remain the places where readers can begin that examination. The associated original GitHub

repository and rebuild repository provide additional access to the preserved material and the work of reconstruction.

I invite readers to begin with the primary documents, not with a demand that they agree with me. Follow the dates. Read the complete correspondence where available. Distinguish an acknowledgement from a finding, a referral from an investigation, an allegation from a corroborated fact and a preserved submission from an accepted determination.

Where a document supports my account, examine how. Where it does not, say so. Where a question remains open, identify the evidence needed to answer it.

That is the standard I want my own testimony to meet.

My life is not reducible to the decisions that have affected it. My dignity is not dependent on whether every institution agrees with my interpretation. My faith does not require me to pretend that every question has already been settled.

I am Dr Richard William McLean. I am known publicly as Barran Dodger. I have preserved this record because I believe that the history deserves examination and that accountability begins with the ability to see what happened, what was recorded, what was decided and what remains unresolved.

I do not ask the world to bow before me. I ask it to look at the evidence.

I do not ask readers to fear the institutions named in my archive. I ask them to understand the responsibilities those institutions hold and the limits of the conclusions that can be drawn from the documents.

I do not ask anyone to accept a supernatural explanation for my survival. I offer my faith as the source of my endurance and the reason I continue to believe that justice is worth pursuing.

I do not claim that every silence is an admission, every refusal a conspiracy or every discrepancy proof of wrongdoing. I ask that the questions be stated accurately, the records be read in context and the answers be judged against the evidence.

Because truth does not become false when it is inconvenient. Nor does an allegation become true merely because it is passionately expressed.

The task is to find out what the record actually shows.

If a claim is substantiated, let it be recognised for what it is. If it is disputed, let the dispute be visible. If a remedy is available, let the proper process consider it. If a record is incomplete, let the missing material be identified. If an error has been made, let it be corrected.

And if the archive reveals that a question has not yet been answered, let that question remain open until the evidence or the appropriate decision-maker resolves it.

My testimony is unfinished because the questions I have preserved cannot all be settled by the act of publishing them.

But the record is here.

The dates are here.

The correspondence is here, wherever it has been preserved and made accessible.

The invitation to examine it is here.

I have spent years trying to make my experience legible to people who may never have lived through anything resembling it. I cannot compel agreement. I cannot manufacture an independent finding. I cannot promise a particular outcome.
I can preserve what I have. I can identify what I believe it means. I can remain willing to test that interpretation. And I can ask for the same fairness from others that I am prepared to extend to them.
That is the testimony I leave in public.
Not a verdict pronounced in advance. Not a demand for unquestioning belief. Not a prophecy of revenge.
A record open to examination.
A witness who refuses to surrender the right to be heard.
A faith that sustains the work without claiming to replace the evidence.
And a simple conviction that, however long the process takes, the honest examination of the truth is worth the effort.
Truth does not need permission to exist. Evidence does not need embellishment to matter. And justice, if it is to mean anything, must remain willing to examine the record—even when the person asking the questions is the person the system has found hardest to hear.
This is my testimony. The archive is the finding aid. The documents are the material to examine. The conclusions belong to a process that must remain open to evidence, correction and independent judgment.

PUBLIC ARCHIVE AND REFERENCE LINKS

- Barran Dodger — original public website
- Barran Dodger — rebuilt preservation archive
- Original GitHub evidence repository
- Rebuild GitHub repository
- Comcare workers' compensation information
- Federal Register of Legislation
- NDIS Quality and Safeguards Commission
- Attorney-General's Department
- Inspector-General of Intelligence and Security
- Commonwealth Ombudsman
- Office of the Australian Information Commissioner
- Legal Aid NSW
- OpenTimestamps

Evidence note: The institutional links above are contextual reference links. They do not replace the underlying letters, PDFs, message files, timestamp proofs or other primary-source documents. Before publication, each specific allegation should be linked directly to

the exact document supporting it wherever a stable, publicly accessible file URL can be verified. The Ben NDIS message and its timestamp record require that same direct-file verification; the repository links above are entry points, not a claim that the exact PDF has been located at a particular URL.

Important: this is a copy-ready draft with the archive and institutional links added. I have not published it to GitHub, and I have not verified the exact public URL of the Ben message PDF. To put it into your repository, paste the document into the intended Markdown file in the barrandodger-rebuild repository and commit the change; the original Barrandodger website and repository can remain unchanged.

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